

# Which script do I run?

A plain-language guide to every launcher in the ELI v2.0 portable package. No experience needed.

## ★ START HERE – THE ONLY THING MOST PEOPLE NEED

Open a terminal in this folder and type these two lines:

```
chmod +x ELI_Setup.sh # do this once – makes the file runnable
./ELI_Setup.sh # installs everything and opens ELI
```

That's it. This one command installs ELI, sets it up, and launches it for you. Everything else in this guide is either something this command does *for* you, or an option for people who want more control.

Two tiny things that appear above, explained:

- `chmod +x` just means "allow this file to run." You only ever do it once.
- The `./` in front means "run the file that's right here in this folder."

## Not sure? Pick the row that sounds like you

| If this is you...                              | Type this                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Just make it work."                           | <code>./ELI_Setup.sh</code>                                  |
| Install now, open it myself later              | <code>./INSTALL_ELI.sh</code> then <code>./RUN_ELI.sh</code> |
| My computer has <b>no NVIDIA graphics card</b> | <code>./INSTALL_ELI.sh --cpu-only</code>                     |
| I want ELI's AI brain + voices too             | <code>./RUN_ELI.sh --with-github-assets</code>               |
| Use ELI from my <b>phone or tablet</b>         | <code>./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https</code>            |
| I'm on <b>Windows</b>                          | <code>install.bat</code>                                     |
| I'm a developer building packages              | Ignore <code>build_packages.sh</code> — not for using ELI    |

### ► One thing to know: ELI needs an AI "brain" file

A fresh copy comes **without** the large AI model (to keep the download small), so the `models` folder starts empty. ELI won't answer until a model is added. The easy setup offers to fetch it for you. To do it by hand:

```
gh auth login # log in to GitHub, one time
./RUN_ELI.sh --with-github-assets # downloads the AI brain + voices,
then opens ELI
```

## Every file in the folder, explained

The three most people use — pick one and go

### ELI\_Setup.sh

★ The recommended one-click. The "do everything for me" button.

|                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WHEN TO USE    | Your first time, or any time you want the easy path.                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| TYPE THIS      | <code>./ELI_Setup.sh</code>                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| WHAT HAPPENS   | Sets up ELI end-to-end: builds its private workspace, installs everything it needs, prepares its memory, offers to download the AI brain + voices, adds a desktop icon and an <code>eli</code> shortcut, then opens ELI with a friendly wizard. |
| IN PLAIN WORDS | The green "go" button. If unsure, this is the one.                                                                                                                                                                                              |

### INSTALL\_ELI.sh

Set ELI up now — but don't open it yet.

|                |                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WHEN TO USE    | You want to install now and start ELI yourself later.                                                                                      |
| TYPE THIS      | <code>./INSTALL_ELI.sh</code> (add <code>--cpu-only</code> if you have no NVIDIA card)                                                     |
| WHAT HAPPENS   | Installs everything and prepares ELI's memory, and adds the <code>eli</code> shortcut and desktop icon — but does <b>not</b> open the app. |
| IN PLAIN WORDS | "Get it ready, I'll open it myself." Afterwards, run <code>RUN_ELI.sh</code> .                                                             |

## RUN\_ELI.sh

► Open ELI. Your everyday button.

**WHEN TO USE** Every day, to start ELI. Safe even if you haven't installed yet — it'll install first if needed.

**TYPE THIS** `./RUN_ELI.sh`

**HANDY EXTRAS** `--with-github-assets` (grab the AI brain + voices first) · `--safe-mode` (if something's misbehaving) · `--trace` (detailed logs for troubleshooting)

**IN PLAIN WORDS** The "open ELI" button you'll use most.

### For people who want more control

## install.sh

The full manual installer for Linux & macOS.

**WHEN TO USE** You're comfortable in a terminal and want direct control. (The one-click setup uses this under the hood.)

**TYPE THIS** `bash install.sh`

**WHAT HAPPENS** Builds ELI's workspace with the exact, tested set of components, checks your graphics card works, and prepares its data folders — but doesn't add the friendly `eli` shortcut or open the app.

**HANDY EXTRAS** `--cpu-only` · `--skip-torch` · `--latest` (newest parts instead of the tested set) · `--install-cuda`

**IN PLAIN WORDS** "The manual installer." Most people should use `ELI_Setup.sh` instead.

## install.bat · install.ps1

The installer for Windows.

**WHEN TO USE** You're on Windows. `install.bat` is the one you double-click; it runs `install.ps1` for you.

**TYPE THIS** `install.bat` (or `install.bat /cpu` for no graphics card)

**IN PLAIN WORDS** "The Windows installer." Prefer the `Setup.exe` from the Releases page if you'd rather just double-click.

## eli.sh · eli · eli-v2.0.desktop

Small launchers the setup creates for you.

**ELI.SH** The bare-bones "start" file. Only works after installing. `RUN_ELI.sh` is the friendlier version.

**ELI** A shortcut the setup installs so you can just type `eli` from anywhere to open ELI. (If it ever runs an old copy, type `hash -r` once.)

**ELI-V2.0.DESKTOP** The clickable icon that appears in your applications menu after setup. You don't run this by hand.

## Special-purpose

### scripts/eli\_serve.sh

📱 Use ELI from your phone or tablet.

**TYPE THIS** `./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https`

**WHAT HAPPENS** Opens ELI to devices on your home Wi-Fi and prints a web address (and a QR code, in the app's *Connect a phone* tab) to open on your phone. `--https` is what lets the phone use its **microphone**.

**IN PLAIN WORDS** "Talk to ELI from the couch." It still runs on this computer — nothing goes to the cloud.

## build\_packages.sh

For developers only — you can ignore this.

**WHAT IT IS** A tool that *builds* the download packages other people install. It does not run or install ELI for use.

**IN PLAIN WORDS** Not for using ELI. Leave it alone.

## Once it's running — day to day

- Open ELI: `./RUN_ELI.sh`, or type `eli`, or click the ELI icon in your menu.
- Phone / tablet: `./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https`
- Your data stays here: memories and settings live inside this folder (`artifacts/` and `config/`). Back up or move the whole folder and nothing is lost.

### If something goes wrong

- "Virtual environment not found" → you opened it before installing. Run `./ELI_Setup.sh` first.
- Install fails on graphics-card bits → reinstall with `./INSTALL_ELI.sh --cpu-only`.
- ELI won't answer / has no brain → fetch the model:  
`./RUN_ELI.sh --with-github-assets`
- Acting strangely at startup → try `./RUN_ELI.sh --safe-mode`.

ELI runs entirely on your own computer and is **offline by default** — it only reaches the internet when you switch on the **Net** toggle inside the app.